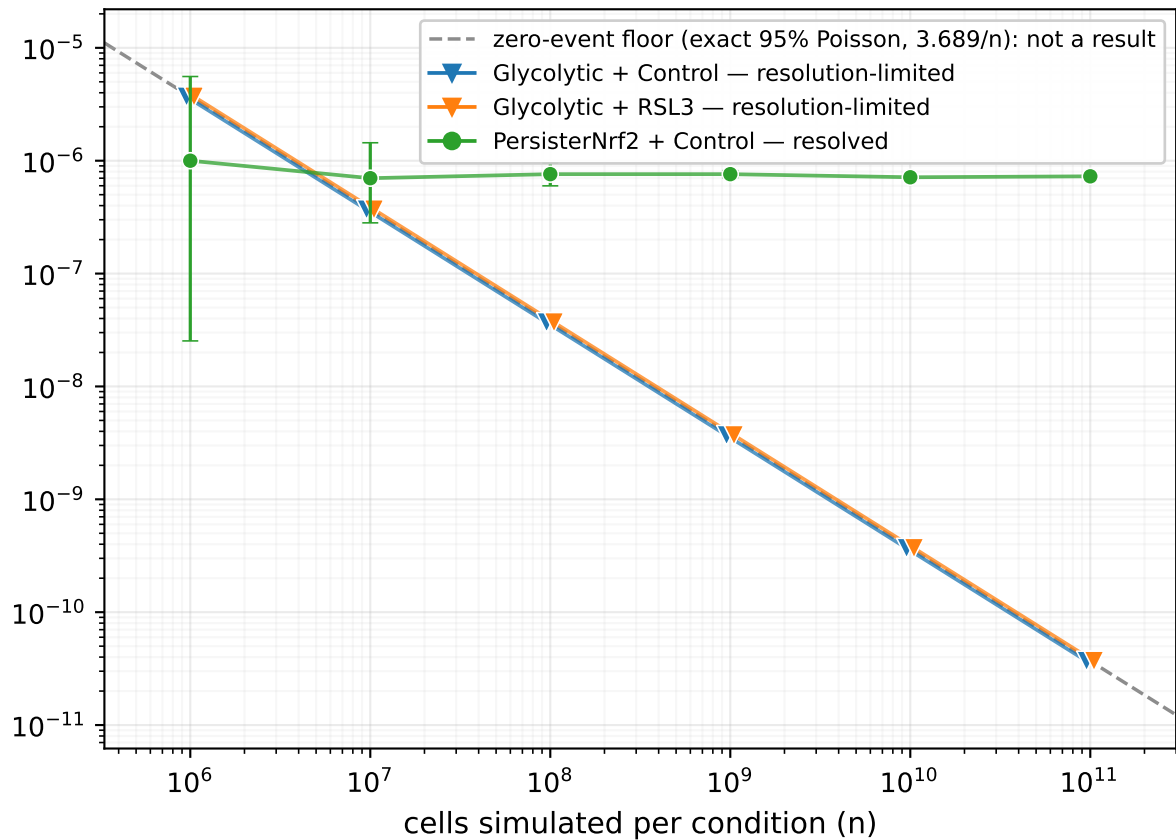


death rate — 95% upper bound where no events were seen

How far down the tail a given sample size can see



Triangles are zero-event runs plotted at their upper bound: the true rate is somewhere below. Circles are measured rates with exact Poisson intervals. A series lying ON the dashed line is reporting the sample size, not the biology. The floor is the exact 95% Poisson upper limit at zero events, $3.689/n$, not the round $3/n$ of the rule of three. Zero-event series are identical by construction, so they are offset horizontally by a few percent to keep each one visible.